

Government be administered according to law’ *Fairchild v. Hughes*, 258 U. S. 126, 129 [1922].” *Baker v. Carr*, 369 U. S. 186, 208 (1962). See *Schlesinger v. Reservists Committee to Stop the War*, *supra*, at 216–222; *Laird v. Tatum*, 408 U. S. 1 (1972); *Ex parte Levitt*, 302 U. S. 633 (1937). Such claims amount to little more than attempts “to employ a federal court as a forum in which to air . . . generalized grievances about the conduct of government.” *Flast v. Cohen*, 392 U. S., at 106.

In finding that respondents had alleged something more than “the generalized interest of all citizens in constitutional governance,” *Schlesinger*, *supra*, at 217, the Court of Appeals relied on factual differences which we do not think amount to legal distinctions. The court decided that respondents’ claim differed from those in *Schlesinger* and *Richardson*, which were predicated, respectively, on the Incompatibility and Accounts Clauses, because “it is at the very least arguable that the Establishment Clause creates in each citizen a ‘personal constitutional right’ to a government that does not establish religion.” 619 F. 2d, at 265 (footnote omitted). The court found it unnecessary to determine whether this “arguable” proposition was correct, since it judged the mere allegation of a legal right sufficient to confer standing.

This reasoning process merely disguises, we think with a rather thin veil, the inconsistency of the court’s results with our decisions in *Schlesinger* and *Richardson*. The plaintiffs in those cases plainly asserted a “personal right” to have the Government act in accordance with their views of the Constitution; indeed, we see no barrier to the *assertion* of such claims with respect to any constitutional provision. But assertion of a right to a particular kind of Government conduct, which the Government has violated by acting differently, cannot alone satisfy the requirements of Art. III without draining those requirements of meaning.